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விவசாயத் திணைக்களம்
Department of Agriculture

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Crop Establishment – Rice

Nursery Systems

- When transplanting is practiced, seedlings are used as the planting material.
- Seedlings should be raised in a nursery for 12-14 days.
- Nurseries could be raised as
    - **wet-bed nurseries**
    - **dry-bed nurseries**
    - **dapog nurseries**
- Raising seedlings for seedling broadcasting need special planting trays (parachute trays). Such nurseries are called parachute nurseries.

Crop establishment

- Crop establishment is the establishment of seeds or seedlings in the field to obtain a successful crop with an optimum potential yield.
- Two main methods are practiced in Sri Lanka (extent of crop established with each method is given in Table 1).
    - Broadcasting
        - Direct sowing

    - Seedling broadcasting (Parachute method)
  - Transplanting
- The choice of the method of establishment depends on factors such as,
    - “age” of the variety
    - soil moisture level
    - climatic conditions
    - availability of inputs and labor

Table 1: Extent of crops established under different methods (2019/20 Yala and 2020 Maha)

Method of crop establisment	**2019/20Maha**	**2020 Yala**
Broadcasting	97.8%	96.4%
Row transplanating	0.5 %	0.9%
Random transplanting	0.5%	1.1%
Parachute (seedling broadcasting)	1.2%	1.5%
Others	–	0.1